

What is inheritance and why is it important?

Inheritance is a technique that is object-oriented where a class gets its variables and methods from a separate class. The original class is the parent class, and the others are the child classes. The child classes “inherit” from the parent class. This can simplify code dramatically if the child classes need to share a lot of the same methods. If changes need to be made they can be done in the parent class instead of each and every class. An easy example of this would be a Vehicle, Car, Motorcycle and Boat class. The Vehicle class can be the parent class with methods that each of the others share.

In the last project I utilized inheritance in a Mindfulness Activity Program that had three different activities. Rather than write an intro and outro method for each activity, I made one in the parent class that each of the child classes used.

```
Public class Reflection Activity : Activity
```

```
DisplayStartingMessage();
```